

Qatar

Ratio: 11:28 **Adopted:** c. 1949 **Usage:** National and Civil



The maroon coloring and proportions distinguish the flag from Bahrain's flag

"Qatar maroon" derives from the action of sun on natural red dye

Asia



Formerly linked to Bahrain, **Qatar** was in a treaty relationship with Britain from 1916 until 1971, when it gained full independence.

Qatar's flag was originally plain red, like the flag of Bahrain, to which it was once linked. The peoples of both countries are Kharijite Muslims, whose traditional banner was red. The flag evolved in its present form around the middle of the 19th century, and was officially adopted when Qatar became independent from Britain in 1971.

"QATAR MAROON"

The flag's maroon color is said to have come about from the action of the desert sun's heat on the red vegetable dyes formerly used for its flags. This color, now known as "Qatar maroon," was officially adopted in 1948. The nine-pointed,

zigzag, white interlock derives from a British request in the 1820s that all friendly states around the Gulf add a white band to their flags, to distinguish them from pirate flags. During its earlier usage, before Qatar's independence, the flag also bore the name of the state in white lettering and red diamonds were placed on the white band.

THE EMBLEM OF QATAR

The circular badge of Qatar uses both the colors and serrated pattern of the flag, around its edge. In the center is a local sailing boat, passing an island. This is set between two crossed swords. It is inscribed with the name of the state in Arabic.